

Poetry Study





About the Course

This course helps students explore and enjoy poems on many levels; lessons include practice in both reading and writing about poetry.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 10



Placement & Combining Tips

Prerequisite: Grade 9 Poetry Study or a familiarity with a variety of poems and a strong working understanding of poetic forms and terminology.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
10	Poetry Study: Grade 10 2 times/week 15 min	The Word Made Fresh Poetry Anthology

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 10				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	Poetry Study: Grade 10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Poetry Study: Grade 10

☐ You'll need a journal and a poetry anthology or two of your choice for this course, as well as the assigned book. A few suggested anthologies are listed in Extra Helpings.

Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.



∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Poetry Study: Grade 10



The Word Made Fresh

Poetry Anthology



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

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or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



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How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 1

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ INTRO

Do you enjoy poetry? Wonderful! This book will give you new ways to get to know and enjoy poems even more deeply. Do you dislike poetry? Perfect! This book will give you a new perspective and hopefully help you to decide simply to put *some* poems aside for now. There is no need to give up on poetry altogether.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Foreword p.ix-xiii

- Think back over your life. What poems have shaped you? Did you listen to nursery rhymes when you were little? Have you memorized poems over the years? How would you describe your relationship with poetry?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

The back of the book has some excellent ideas on how to use the book with a group and includes extra discussion questions for each of the chapters if you're interested!

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 2

Materials: Journal

→ INTRO

One lesson each week will focus on reading and discussing our way through The Word Made Fresh. The second lesson will focus on reading poetry or engaging with it in some way. Keep a journal on hand! Sometimes specific poems are assigned, but sometimes you will need to choose a poem to read yourself (with some guidance). Make sure to have a good poetry anthology on hand. Some options are linked in Extra Helpings.

→ REFLECT

What habits have helped or hindered your capacity to spend time with wonder? What moments in your life made the world feel bigger? What caused it?

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 3

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-3 "Poetry fills" - "might meet."

- What did you think about the idea that God delights in poetry?

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 4

Materials: Bible

→ READ & REFLECT

Read a poem from the Bible (the Psalms are an easy place to start, but almost a third of the Bible is poetry, so you'll run into it everywhere). Why do you think God has written to us in poetry?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 5

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.3-6 "Walt Whitman" - "read a poem."

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Term 1

- Do you believe that poetry is for you?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 6

Materials: Journal

→ REFLECT

Have you ever been moved to worship God by a poem or song (often poems put to music)? Describe the experience.

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 7

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.6-11 "I don't know" - "wrenching things awry."

- What do you think of the idea that poetry helps us see the world with fresh eyes? Can you think of anything else that has that quality?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 8

Materials: Bible

→ READ & REFLECT

Read another biblical poem today and reflect on how the Bible would be different if God had given that piece of scripture to us as prose rather than a poem.

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 9

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-12 "Wilbur's poem" - "make things fresh."

- Think about the idea that we live by metaphor. What metaphors do you use regularly? Have you noticed how ideas "strike" or "seize" or "capture" us, and thought about the violent battle imagery we use to talk about ideas?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 10

Materials: Journal

→ REFLECT

What metaphors do you live by? Think about these common ones and then reflect on whether they are helpful ways to think about each of these things, and what other metaphors we might be unconsciously acting on.

- Time is Money: We understand time as a finite resource that can be saved, spent, wasted, or invested.
- Love is a Physical Force: We experience love as a force of attraction or magnetism.
- Life is a Journey: We see life as a path with destinations, detours, and crossroads.
- Arguments are War: We engage in arguments by attacking, defending, and making counterattacks.
- The Brain is a Machine: We conceptualize the brain as a complex system with internal parts and processes.

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Term 1

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 11

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.12-16 "The more we know" - "at a time."

• EXTRA HELPINGS
Listen to this talk by Frederick Buechner on paying attention.
∞ Audio Link: Lecture by Buchner

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 12

Materials: Anthology

→ READ & REFLECT
Revisit a poem you have enjoyed in your life so far. It can be any poem by any author.

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 13

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.16-18 "So let us" - "do is read."

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 14

Materials: Anthology or online

→ READ & REFLECT
Revisit another poem you have liked in the past.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 15

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.21-23 "But how" - "poem complete."

• What do you think of the quote by Auden that a "sign that a book has literary value 'is that it can be read in a number of different ways'?"

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 16

Materials: Anthology

→ READ & REFLECT
Choose an anthology of poems and flip through it. Don't stop until you find a poem that resonates with you somehow. Jot down what caught you and what you liked about it (simple or profound).

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 17

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.24-29 "Take my own" - "of the cast."

• Can you think of any poems that have resonated strongly with you because of a particular experience?

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Term 1

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 18

Materials: Anthology

→ READ & REFLECT

Go on the hunt for poems in a poetry anthology or the Bible that catch your attention. What did you resonate with?

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 19

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.29-35 "Those stories" - "in silence."

- What do you think of the idea that a poem can affect us beyond what an author intended? Have you ever experienced a situation where your words impacted someone negatively or positively beyond what you intended (or vice versa)?

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 20

Materials: Anthology

→ READ & REFLECT

Read more poems today! Feel free to look up poets mentioned in the chapter or browse at leisure through your anthology.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 21

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.35-41 "The longings" - "on the page."

- What is the difference between reading "personally" and reading pridefully?

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 22

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 23

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 24

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

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Term 2

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 25

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.42-44 "As we begin" - "move on."

- In what situations should you NOT heed the author's advice to just move on if you don't like something? Sometimes we have to work to enjoy something and look for ways to make it interesting for ourselves. But sometimes it is ok to just acknowledge that something is not our personal preference and move on. Notice that the author is not saying give up on POETRY, but just on a particular poem that doesn't strike you.

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 26

Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ READ & REFLECT
Find a poem that compels you to respond. What was the connection? How did you respond? Note your likes and dislikes.

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 27

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.45-47 "So let us suppose" - "its wake."

- What does an ideal poem look like for you?

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 28

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT
Reflect on the second question Van Engen raises: what do you think draws others to the Williams or Hopkins poems you've read in this chapter? How does this question help us nuance what it means to read "personally" versus proudly?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 29

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.47-50 "So let us" - "right sort of way."

- What does Van Engen mean when he asks if a poem generates a response?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 30

Materials: Journal

→ REFLECT
Start your own personal anthology of poems that you enjoy and any poems or poets you know you want to investigate further.

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Term 2

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 31

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.50-52 "For readers" - "of blackness."

- What poems do you know of that meditate on scripture? Have you ever found it edifying to meditate on scripture poetically?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 32

Materials: Journal

→ WRITE
Write a poem about something in scripture.

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 33

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.52-55 "Oftentimes" - "ever since."

- Describe how poetry can help us see new facets of the Bible and cause us to wonder at it afresh.

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 34

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT
Revisit one of the poems in this chapter so far and write down any new impressions or insights.

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 35

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.55-59 "Words in Scripture" - "different effects."

- What type of form appeals to you?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 36

Materials: Anthology and Journal

→ REFLECT
Flip through your anthology until you find another poem you resonate with. Jot down the title and what drew you to it.

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 37

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
p.59-62 "Some poems" - "try more."

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Term 2

- Did you notice how Van Engen describes what he means by whether a poem causes a response? Read the questions at the top of p.62 again. What do you think of these questions?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 38

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Look up another poem or more about the poet you've liked the most so far in this chapter.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 39

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.62-66 "Many readers" - "is read."

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 40

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT

Tell which poem in the chapter you liked the most and why.

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 41

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.66-67 "As you wander" - "not for me."

- What do you think of the author's suggestion not to worry about the Very Important Poets? Remember that the author is writing mainly about enjoying poetry for life. He is not saying that if you are reading one of the Very Important Poets in a high school or college class, you don't have to pay attention and try to enjoy and understand them.

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 42

Materials: Anthology

→ READ

Read more poems for pleasure in your anthology. Jot down the titles in your personal anthology!

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 43

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.67-68 "Poetry, I assure" - "that happens."

- What do you think about the idea that poems thrive in community? Have you ever shared a poem with someone? If you did, what poem would you share? Share a poem with someone this week and see what they think!

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Term 2

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 44

Materials: Journal

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Look up other poems by the same author as some of the poems you've collected so far this term.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 45

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ CATCH-UP DAY/REFLECTION

This week, ask someone else about poems they have enjoyed. Ask them why they like it.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 46

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 47

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 48

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

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Term 3

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 49

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.69 "The conversations" - "your touch."

- Why do you think starting with the question about a poem's "meaning" can shut down a conversation about it?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 50

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT

Discuss a poem you like using the questions in the first paragraph of your reading last lesson on p.69.

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 51

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.69-72 "Perhaps this" - "poet means."

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 52

Materials: Journal

→ REFLECT

Do you typically ask questions of poems? If yes, what do you ask?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 53

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.72-73 "At the same time" - "to begin."

- Have you ever thought about reading poetry as a conversation before?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 54

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT

Reread Billy Collins "Introduction to Poetry." What images or lines resonate with you?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 55

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.74-77 "Let me" - "minor deed."

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Term 3

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 56

Materials: Anthology & Journal

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pick a poem (one you already like or a new one) with at least two stanzas and ask the following questions:

- Who is acting?
- Who is acted upon?
- Who is the poem addressed to?
- What does the stanza achieve?
- Why does the poem continue?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 57

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.78-80 "So much" - "does it work?"

- Were you surprised at how many things the author found to say about such a short poem?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 58

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ CREATE

Make a bookmark or infographic with Van Engen's 4 Questions on p.80-81 to keep with you as you read. Are any of these questions new ideas for you?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 59

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.81-82 "So we have" - "of particulars."

- What is the similarity between noticing what is going on in a poem and observing nature?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 60

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Anthology

→ REFLECT

Pick a poem (a familiar one or a new one), ask the 4 Questions of it, and jot down your findings.

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 61

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.83-84 "With all that" - "to love."



Term 3

- What do you think of the idea that "poets often use language to show how language falls short"? Have you ever experienced the limits of language? How did that happen?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 62

Materials: The Word Made Fresh, Journal

→ REFLECT

Pick another poem to question or continue asking questions of one of your previous poems.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 63

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.84-86 "Frequently, the devotion" - "to meet."

- What has your faith been formed by? Would you say it has been shaped by wonder and mystery?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 64

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT

Do you tend to rush through life? Slow down and think of a particular situation or moment in your life that you should attend to but tend to rush past. List words that describe the event, emotion, or experience.

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 65

Materials: Journal

→ REFLECT

Pick a poem to reflect on more extensively. It can be new or familiar. Today, just write your thoughts on Question #1 from your bookmark.

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 66

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT

Continue your deeper reflection on a poem. Today, just write your thoughts on Question #2 from your bookmark.

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 67

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT

Continue your deeper reflection on a poem. Today, write your thoughts on Question #3 from your bookmark.

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Term 3

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 68

Materials: The Word Made Fresh

→ REFLECT

Continue your deeper reflection on a poem. Today, write your thoughts on Question #4 from your bookmark.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 69

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, explore Extra Helpings, or slow down and read some poetry.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 70

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, explore Extra Helpings, or slow down and read some poetry.

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 71

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 10 - Lesson 72

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Word Made Fresh

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Examination

Term 1 · What new ideas have you had about poetry this term?

Term 2 · Share a poem with someone that you have enjoyed, or tell about one poem you have enjoyed and why.

Term 3 · What 4 Questions can we ask about?